ACT I: MOTIVE

MERIDIAN / BOARD OFFICE

Board secretary's notice

Grant Larceny has died at the gala after his private toast. The proposed gift remains unsigned and unaccepted. The naming terms

donor control and director's resignation are proposals

not completed decisions.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

MERIDIAN / PRIVATE SERVICE

The service manager's account

The original toast remained booked and paid. The separate added-course charge did not cancel it. After his press interview the donor rejoined the reception; his prepared place was unattended.

6:32 PM	Unwrapped shop glass and set private place for scheduled later toast
After setup	Returned to kitchen / extra-course ticket taken to accounts
7:04 PM	Collected glass
7:06 PM	Poured shared punch in kitchen
7:09 PM	Carried directly to Grant / he accepted the toast

EXAMINATION / RETAINED SAMPLES

Initial laboratory findings

The bottle was found empty in the staff-accessible preparation cupboard. A split beneath the back of its red band was concealed from the front.

Grant's individual glass	Cyanide detected
Shared punch and food	Cyanide not detected
Loan bottle residue	Active cyanide detected

ACT III: METHOD

COLLECTION / PURCHASE AND INTAKE

The acquired bottle

Unused band stock retains its red face and silver backing. The glass scrap is similar stock

without a unique torn-edge match. Ordinary staff keys open the storage cupboard after the preview.

Executed purchase	Original contents must remain / no empty bottle or replica
Seller's fulfillment	Original contents retained / no cancellation or substitution instruction received
Intake	Closed bottle received / lender calls contents inert
Intake attachment	Dealer's forwarding note and complete seller condition received before gala
Treatment band	New red foil-backed paper across stopper
Closed preview	6:20–6:28 PM
After death	Concealed rear split / similar paper scrap in glass

ACT III: METHOD

The acquired bottle / retained comparisons



The physical glass bottle is on an open support during the closed preview. No fixed glass front encloses the bench.

Treatment drawing shows band crossing the stopper. Front condition view and separate rear-split view show different sides. Retained strip and glass scrap show red paper with silver backing.

Original signed condition sheet dates the closure treatment October 30, 2026. Chip's insurance copy changes that date to October 29. Both copies describe the same treatment.

ACT III: METHOD

PRIVATE SERVICE / ORIGINAL ORDER

The prepared place and delivered toast

Original order	Paid private toast / individual culinary flavoring
Shared pitcher	Cyanide absent / requested flavoring absent
Retained ingredient container	Cyanide absent / requested flavoring present
Grant's glass	Cyanide present / requested flavoring present
Shop receipt	Engraved crest glass received before setup





Entire private place visible with bare engraved glass. No wrapping or transparent hood surrounds it.

Grant has the crest glass at his lips. The offered water bottle remains sealed aside.

ACT III: METHOD

PRESS DESK / UNTRIMMED RECORDING

The beginning of the press interview

SERVICE MANAGER: Mr. Larceny, I'll leave your glass here. I'm going back to the kitchen about that added course.

GRANT: Thank you. Paige, I asked for a quiet private place. Why have you followed me here?

PAIGE: You agreed to an interview about the gift. It's on the recorder.

GRANT: It's the gala. I'm announcing the gift tonight. Ask about that, or we'll speak tomorrow.

ROBIN: Grant, here is your copy. The museum already has one. Return the bowl intact or give the claimants a hearing.

GRANT: This is my private room, Robin, not the public podium. I'm already answering the reporter. I am not reading a petition here.

SECURITY / TECHNICIAN'S WORK ORDER

What was disconnected?

Requested	Remove private room from live monitor
Approved work	Remove camera power adapter
Technician account	Power removed / network lead left attached
Recording while unpowered	None
Tech demonstrator	Supplied sample images / proposed connection to existing room camera

Power adapter is unplugged; network lead remains attached. Clear labels identify power and network separately.

ACT III: METHOD

PRODUCTION / RECIPIENT'S WORKING FILE

What was actually delivered?

Studio master received before gala. Picture and original sound retained together.

Production log / received before gala: studio chair; empty jacket falls; empty chair remains.

Original sound cue: studio assistant calls "Jacket take"; chair scrapes; empty jacket strikes floor with a clatter.

Press desk comparison: the untrimmed podcast export retains "Jacket take," chair scrape and clatter in the same continuous studio sequence. Its shortened teaser begins after the spoken cue.

Screen delivery	Studio take of empty jacket falling / original clatter sound retained
Donor reply	No live stunt involving me or any guest / submit screen version only
Final status	Screen version also rejected
Textile slides	Enlarged stitches / no object-image slides
Preview revision	Proposed glass front omitted from installed bench
Alcove	Hanging load removed / visitor route closed
Styling copies	Donor-place hood crossed out on both copies



Studio frames show an empty jacket falling from the chair. Pattern contact sheet shows only enlarged weaving.

ACT III: METHOD

EDUCATION / ASSISTANT DOCENT'S COMPLETED NOTE

The short tour

Alcove closed. Group turned back and continued to the public collection cases. We did not enter the donor room or stop beside the donor place.

Marked route	Donor room excluded / alcove turnback
School places	Funded from discretionary workshop account
Budget consequence	Paid weekend session canceled

BOARD OFFICE / RUNNING ORDER

Copies in the announcement folder

Coordinator's announcement copy and donor's private copy are separate. The unsigned master was withdrawn at the announcement desk.

Director's refusal	No accepted gift without board approval / museum will forgo donation
Legal objection	Stop public acceptance announcement / original private hospitality may proceed
Attached advice	Ownership objection retained with earlier acquisition advice
Family succession proposal	Donor seat passes to family successor only upon board acceptance
Family request	Ask whether family appointment can be made during donor's lifetime

ACT III: METHOD

COLLECTION / STAFF AND PRESS COPIES

Working proof and intake reply

Working query	Original contents condition conflicts with inert loan description
Intake reply	Unresolved / keep bottle closed
Staff delivery	Full query and restriction
Press delivery	Shortened inert entry / original-contents sentence omitted
Bowl label	Settled ownership withdrawn / missing-document warning retained
Founding practice	Lender descriptions previously used before supporting papers
Later policy	Shortcut withdrawn / supporting review required
Staff cupboard access	Retained founder's spare and ordinary staff keys tested / both open current lock

Pre-gala working proof dated October 29. Query signed Dr. Art E. Fact: "Seller requires original contents. Lender calls contents inert. Please clarify before opening." Intake reply: "Unresolved. Keep closed." Reed DeLabel's press markup strikes the sentence "Purchase condition requires original contents to remain." Staff delivery retains full query and seller attachment; press delivery takes shortened inert caption.

ACT III: METHOD

SALES AND PUBLICITY / RETAINED COPIES

The collectors' working papers

Proposed sale	Bowl withdrawn / historical bottle remains loan and not for sale
Artist delivery	Painting only / no model substitution authorized
Reproduction agreement	Permission withheld / final commission payment may be withheld
Endorsement	Withdrawal received before public announcement
Family valuation	Damaged comparison used for intact family object
Installation invoice	Issued by Elon Mosaic before any connection was installed / refused by accounts



The artist's reference plate shows a visibly joined painted wooden lighting block. The preview shows the distinct historical glass bottle.

Original uncropped society frame shows public gallery and podium. Crop removes the disputed purchase; the setting is not the private donor place.

ACT III: METHOD

PRESS / SOURCES AND CORRECTIONS

What the press desk retained

Claim letter	Claimants identified / no ministry-issued return order
Historical clipping	Earlier owner's name corrected / no neutralization statement

AGENCY / PICTURE EDITOR'S RECEIPT

Camera-card handover

This import covers frames captured before handover. The later toast photograph was not on the card at that time.

Source handover	Camera card after preview
Editor action	Complete original import retained before card return
Later action	Photographer prepared agency export
Retained preview frame	Contains physical bottle on open support
Earlier gallery retouch	Commercial image supplied as editorial

ACT III: METHOD

COMMISSIONS / DELIVERY AND SETTLEMENT ATTACHMENTS

Workshop and handling records

Sculpture contract	Cold-cast resin with metal powder / revised label / reduced final settlement
Sculpture surface sample	Bronze powder and gold transfer leaf / not red foil-backed paper
Handling report	Frame corner damaged in delivery / first report calls it old damage
Payroll ledger	Restricted-fund transfer paid staff wages / authorization absent
Textile merchant payment	Gala panel fabric paid from advance assigned to another client commission



Two dated handling photographs of the same loan frame. Before delivery the corner is intact; the receiving photograph shows the new corner crack. The handler's first report calls it old damage; the signed correction records damage in delivery.